Walk Into Your Husband's Care-Plan Meeting Knowing What to Ask

Put your priorities in order, compare them with the provider's written plan, separate questions from disagreements, and set up a record that captures who agreed to what.

Where you are

Your husband has been in the facility three weeks, and the care-plan meeting is next Tuesday. You have a list of things you asked for in the first week, a copy of something the staff called the care plan, and no idea which of your requests actually made it in.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can name your top priorities for him, point to where each one does or doesn't appear in the provider's written plan, and leave the meeting with every item marked agreed, deferred, or open, with a name next to it.

A one-page meeting record, ready to fill in: Our Priorities, Where the Plan Addresses Them, Questions to Ask, Decisions for the Clinicians, and Agreed, Deferred, or Open with Owner and Date.

Before you start

- Your list of what you've asked the staff for since he arrived.
- Whatever the provider has given you that they call the care plan, even if it's hard to read.
- The meeting date and who you've been told will be there. If you don't have the plan yet, ask for it and begin with your list.

PROMPT 1

Put your priorities in order

WHY THIS MATTERS

You'll get a limited amount of time in the room. If everything is a priority, the staff will pick what to address, and it may not be what matters most to him.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your running list of requests, concerns, and things you know about how he likes things done.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My husband is in a care facility and we have a care-plan meeting coming up. Here is everything I've asked for, worried about, or want the staff to know since he arrived:

> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Sort it into three groups: MATTERS MOST TO HIM (comfort, dignity, routines, things he has said), MATTERS MOST FOR HIS CARE (things I've noticed that staff should know about), and HOUSEKEEPING (small practical items). Within each group, put the most important first and tell me how you ordered it so I can disagree. Then suggest which three or four items I should raise first if time runs short. Don't judge whether any request is reasonable; that's for the meeting.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Whether your top three are really about him, or about your frustration. Both are valid; only one belongs at the top.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Check the order with one other family member who knows him well.

PROMPT 2

Compare your list with what's written in their plan

WHY THIS MATTERS

Asking for something and having it written into the plan are different things. The plan is what the staff on the next shift will read. If it's not there, it isn't happening reliably.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your sorted priorities and the provider's written plan, as given to you.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are my priorities for my husband's care, in order:
>
> [PASTE THE SORTED LIST FROM PROMPT 1]
>
> Here is the written care plan the facility gave us:
>
> [PASTE OR TYPE THE PLAN TEXT, WITH NAMES REMOVED]
>
> For each of my priorities, tell me whether it is CLEARLY ADDRESSED, PARTLY OR VAGUELY ADDRESSED, or NOT MENTIONED in the plan, and quote the plan's own words where it is addressed. Where the plan uses clinical or facility terms I might not understand, list them separately as WORDS TO ASK ABOUT. Do not explain what the clinical terms mean or what the plan's medical content implies. I'll ask the staff.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The 'not mentioned' rows. Those are the questions for Tuesday, not accusations.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Write a one-line question for each 'not mentioned' item, starting with 'How does the plan handle...'

PROMPT 3

Separate a question from a disagreement

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most of what feels like a fight is a question nobody has answered. Some differences are real and have reasons. Knowing which is which keeps the meeting about him.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The comparison from prompt 2 and anything the staff have already said no to or explained.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is how my priorities for my husband compare with the facility's written plan, plus anything the staff have already told me:
>
> [PASTE THE COMPARISON FROM PROMPT 2 AND ANY STAFF RESPONSES]
>
> Sort every item into four lists: QUESTIONS (I don't yet know what the plan does or why), REQUESTS (I'd like something added or changed and haven't asked formally), DIFFERENCES WITH A STATED REASON (they've explained why they do it differently), and DIFFERENCES WITH NO REASON GIVEN YET. For the differences, write one calm question that asks for the reason or the constraint. Keep any item about medications, treatment, or his medical condition marked 'for the clinician to decide' and do not suggest what the answer should be.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How short the real-disagreement lists are once the questions are pulled out.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick who will ask the questions and who will take notes. Don't make it the same person.

PROMPT 4

Set up the record you'll fill in at the meeting

WHY THIS MATTERS

The meeting will move fast. If the page you're writing on already has the right columns, you'll leave with owners and dates. If it's blank, you'll leave with a feeling.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm going into my husband's care-plan meeting and want a page I can fill in during it. Here is what I've prepared:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Make me a one-page meeting record with these headings: OUR PRIORITIES (filled in, in order), WHERE THE PLAN ADDRESSES THEM (filled in from the comparison), QUESTIONS TO ASK (filled in), DECISIONS FOR THE CLINICIANS (the medical and treatment items, listed but unanswered), and a table headed AGREED, DEFERRED, OR OPEN with blank columns for status, who owns it, by when, and how it will be written into the plan. Add one blank line at the bottom for the date of the next review. Leave every status blank. Nothing is agreed until it's said in the room.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page with every status column empty and every question written down.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Print two copies for the meeting. The filled-in page comes with you to the step below.

Bring the whole picture of him, not just this week's worries

A care-plan meeting goes better when the family can show who your husband is and what matters to him, not only what went wrong recently. The care interview organizes that into a Family Care Profile you can bring with you.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›